

EXPECTATIONS

An expectation is a bet on the future.

How to align up front before it becomes frustration.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

If it was never said out loud, each of you bet on
something different.

THE CASCADE

How the surprise gets booked.

WHAT YOU SEE

Everyone leaves the meeting thinking they understood...

THE MECHANISM

...each one builds a different film in their head...

THE CONSEQUENCE

...and the gap shows up on delivery day.

Alignment that was never said out loud does not exist, it was assumed.

THE FORK

Three signs you are not aligned.

THREE SIGNALS

01

— ☐ You never heard the person describe the result? Not aligned.

02

— ☐ What is out of scope was never said? Not aligned.

03

— ☒ The risk never came up in the conversation? Not aligned.

| There is no alignment without transparency about the risk.

THE METHOD

Alignment in three beats.

01 **BEFORE**

what success is, what is out, and who I depend on

02 **DURING**

the agreed amber signal, who raises a hand when something moves

03 **AFTER**

the comparison between what was agreed and what arrived, no drama, no blame

Twenty minutes up front save weeks of repair afterward.

WHAT TO SAY, IN ORDER

What has to be said out loud.

01 • BEFORE

For me, done means this.

describe the result as if it already existed

02 • DURING

This part is not included.

what is left out causes more fights than what is in

03 • AFTER

I depend on these two people.

a hidden dependency becomes an excuse at the deadline

04

The biggest risk is this, and I flag it if it hits.

a shared risk stops being a surprise

TWO MODELS

Assuming or agreeing.

THE COMMON MODEL

Assuming

Everyone knows what I want

I state the result, not the limits

The risk stays in my head

The conversation happens in the damage

THE DESIGNED MODEL

Agreeing

I ask the person to describe it

I say what is out of scope

The risk enters the first conversation

The conversation happens up front

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three habits that guarantee a miss.

01 Accepting the request without repeating it back.

→ whoever repeats it finds the gap on the spot, for free.

02 Growing the scope without moving the deadline.

→ the agreement dies in silence and nobody tells anybody.

03 Hiding the risk so as not to sound negative.

→ when it hits, you lose the deadline and the trust together.

Almost every frustration starts as a conversation nobody wanted to have.

THE CHAIN

The what done looks like test.

01 Ask, describe how this will look when it is done.



02 If the description differs from yours...



03 ...the frustration is already on the calendar, only the date is missing.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

Five minutes of description beat an hour of briefing.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

Twenty minutes that prevent the damage.



STEP 01

Write what done means in one sentence, and show it.

if you cannot write it, it is not clear in your own head yet



STEP 02

Say out loud what is not included.

that is the sentence
almost nobody has the
nerve to say



STEP 03

Agree the amber signal, what forces an immediate heads up.

a delay, a scope change, a
blocked dependency

Aligning is not talking more, it is confirming it arrived intact.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

Alignment in Three Beats, in the order that matters.



An aligned expectation does not become frustration. It becomes an agreement.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER

next time someone asks you for something important.

FABIO GARCIA

MANAGEMENT AS ENGINEERING
/IN/FALERCIA